PUBLIC GOODS / WORKSHOP

Putting self-interest to work for the public good

An application of the Decentralized Curation framework

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Who judges what matters?
What do we reward?

Read → Cite → Reuse → Fund

Personal rewards for honest, competent and careful judgment can also create public benefit.

Curate what matters.
Distribute when ready.

Define the goal and criteria Organizing group

Nominate
Claims + evidence + deposit

→

Judge relevance
Drawn jury

→

Relative weights
Funding is one possible use

Challenge claims Appeal a disputed score Reassess periodically

Assessment costs need funding; a beneficiary budget can arrive later

Define the goal.
Publish the criteria.

How much does this nominee's completed and maintained work underpin how research is done, shared and kept, now?

0.00	0.25	0.50	0.75	1.00
not infrastructure	matters to one field	relied on in several fields	widely relied on	critical across research

Evidence + Criteria + Reward rules

One example: research infrastructure

A claim you can check.

> NUMPY 2.0.0
>
> “Released on 16 June 2024.”

Delivery + Downstream use + Migration costs

Real release; illustrative nomination and scores

05 / RELEVANCE JURY

One jury.
Different judgments.

6 seats · 3 jurors

Juror A Seats: 3 — 0.700



Juror B Seats: 2 — 0.400



Juror C Seats: 1 — 0.700



MEAN WEIGHTED BY SEATS

0.600

(3 × 0.70 + 2 × 0.40 + 1 × 0.70) ÷ 6 = 0.600

Seal privately → reveal

Deposits enter a draw for paid jury work; one juror may hold several seats

Dispute a score?
Fund an appeal.

INITIAL JURY

6

seats · score **0.600**

→

CONTESTED APPEAL

12

seats · score **0.700**

8 at 0.800; 4 at 0.500

Competing fully funded scores go to a larger jury.

Intended design: a sole fully funded proposal becomes the score without another jury

Curated shares.
Ready for any budget.

`effective weight = min(requested weight, adopted score)`

WEIGHTS → NORMALIZED SHARES

Nominee	Cap	Score	Weight	Share	Units/day
NumPy	0.800	0.600	0.600	40.0%	**0.00**
Archive	0.700	0.300	0.300	20.0%	**0.00**
Registry	0.600	0.900	0.600	40.0%	**0.00**



NUMPY'S SHARE

40.0%

Illustrative distribution: **0** units/day

`0 × 40.0% = 0.00 units/day`

INITIAL ASSESSMENT; ELIGIBLE FOR FUNDING

Set funding to zero: weights and shares remain. Rates assume the initial waiting period has ended; weights do not measure public benefit.

Challenge claims. Reward fact-checking.

COUNTERFACTUAL CLAIM

> “NumPy 1.x C extensions work unchanged in 2.0.”
>
> These extensions require rebuilding.

Challenge → External arbitrator →

Challenge succeeds?

Deposit to fact-checker; nomination ends

Illustration, not a verdict about NumPy. Future funding stops; previously earned funding remains owed.

Reassess periodically.
Update the weights.

INITIAL SCORE

0.600

→

LATER SCORE

0.300

NUMPY / DAY

25.00

Lower weight takes effect immediately. Earlier accrual stays earned; only future accrual uses the new shares.

A fresh assessment updates current relevance; an appeal contests an existing score

Honesty, care and competence.

HONESTY

Report sincerely.

CARE

Assess evidence rigorously.

COMPETENCE

Know how to judge it.

Private scores; coherence rewarded, incoherence penalized.

Fees support the work. Without trusted collusion, honesty is the intended Schelling point: the shared focal point. Repeated losses reduce relative stake and draw chances; competence selection requires informed judgment to outperform guessing.

Now you are the jury.



https://decentralized-curation.0xferit.workers.dev/r/leiden

Name → seat → score

No wallet. Workshop points only.

Judge the work.
Use the same question.

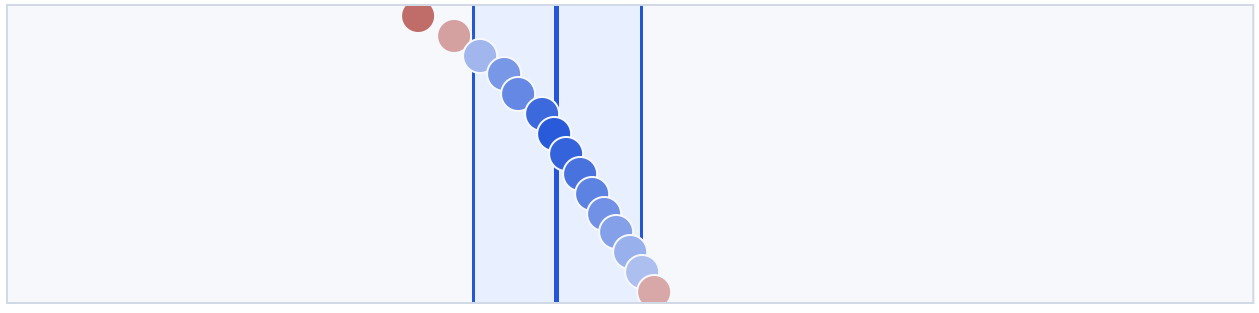
How much does this nominee’s completed and maintained work underpin how research is done, shared and kept, now?

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not infrastructure	matters to one field	relied on in several fields	widely relied on	critical across research

how many rely · role in research · other options

Brief descriptions and prior knowledge; use the shared criteria and explain your evidence.

Your reports move the reference.



centre	spread	band	inside	forfeiting
0.44	0.055	±0.068	12	3

Blue: inside. Red: outside.

CENTRE

Weighted mean

BAND

Spread of reports

POINTS

Closeness inside the band

Workshop simplification; the implementation grades differently.

6 nominees.
Your judgment.

01
Inkscape

02
Linux

03
PDF

04
LaTeX

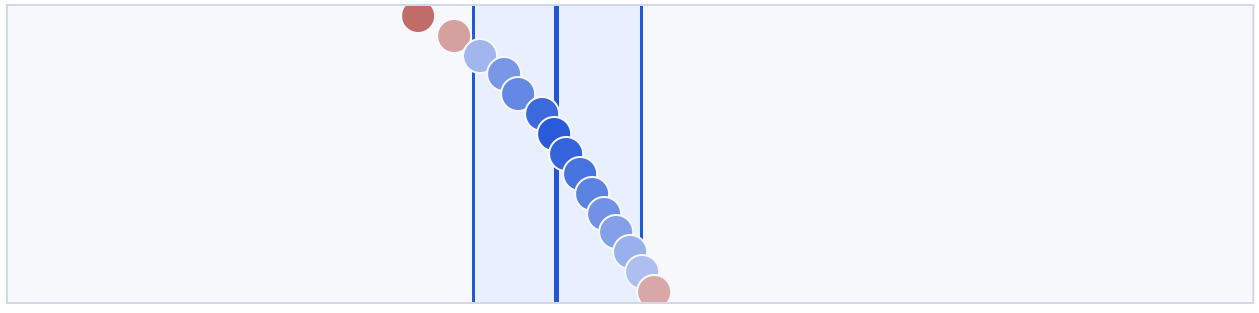
05
arXiv

06
NumPy

Read → Score alone → Seal → Open together

Keep the secret words used to seal your score private. Explain your evidence after revelation.

Did our scores follow the evidence?



centre	spread	band	inside	forfeiting
0.44	0.055	±0.068	12	3

Blue: inside. Red: outside. Outline: assigned bloc at 0.90; lowest starting scores join first.

Bloc share of stake 0%

What did we reward?

What shaped the reference?

What would change your mind?

Similar scores can come from a shared mistake. This exercise does not establish resistance to collusion.

Every defense has a boundary.

Attack	Response	Still exposed
Shift the criteria	Published goal and criteria	Bad policy; shared bias
Copy a score	Commit → reveal	Early reveals; coordination
Capture the jury	Deposit-based draw	Concentrated stake
Keep a bad ruling	Publicly funded appeal	Cost; shared bias
Prove a sealed score to a buyer	Workshop only: penalty + bounty	Other verification routes remain; no equivalent penalty found in the inspected code

Crowdfunded appeals: intended design. Other boundaries: inspected implementation.

Start smaller.
Learn before scaling.

HERE

WORKSHOP

Experience the game

→

PLANNED PRECURSOR

ARROW

Invited experts
Real funding docket

→

DESTINATION

OPEN APPLICATION

Open participation
Adversarial conditions

Arrow assumes honesty, competence and non-collusion; it does not test the open participation incentives.

What would change our minds?

01

UNDERSTAND THE POLICY

02

RESPOND TO EVIDENCE

03

IMPROVE JUDGMENT

04

DELIVER PUBLIC BENEFIT

Assess both personal rewards and public benefit.

Proposed tests; outcomes and thresholds set before evaluation

Make scrutiny worthwhile.

Reward honest, competent and careful judgment.
Make personal benefit serve the public good.

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Keep three scopes separate.

PUBLIC-GOODS APPLICATION

Open juries backed by deposits
Claims + relevance + correction
Funding can follow

ARROW PROPOSAL

Invited experts
Trusted nominations
Bounded experiment

THIS WORKSHOP

People in this room
Points
Teaching exercise

The framework is broader than this application; the workshop illustrates one component.

A funding score is not a juror reward.

FUNDING

ADOPTED SCORE

Jury score or sole funded proposal

INSPECTED IMPLEMENTATION

MEDIAN + DEVIATION

Final jury grades all rounds

WORKSHOP

MEAN + SPREAD

Immediate points

Deviation: median absolute deviation. Workshop uses standard deviation.

Different tools.
A shared assessment problem.

DISCOVERY

MATADISCO

EXPLICIT CRITERIA

ASSESSMENT WORKSHOP

PUBLIC EXPERT REVIEW

THE UNJOURNAL

METRICS + HUMAN REVIEW

OPEN SOURCE ENDOWMENT

Potential complements; no comparative superiority or partnership is claimed.